

The Daily Record

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FRONT PAGE

HOW FLOWERS MADE OUR WORLD

Kirkus Reviews

“We live on a floral planet,” declares award-winning biologist Haskell in a fascinating examination of the enormous impact that flowering plants have had on all life. Flowers appeared about 200 million years ago, following complex animals and other land plants, such as ferns and conifers. Through rapid and continuing doubling of their genome, followed by selective pruning, their advent was dramatic: “By one hundred million years ago,” Haskell writes, “they were the foundation of most habitats on land” proliferating into almost all of the main branches of flowering plants that exist today. Haskell focuses on eight plants in particular: magnolias, which were contemporaneous with dinosaurs; goatsbeard, which responded to environmental stresses by chromosomal doubling; orchids, whose evolutionary survival—an astounding 28,000

species—exemplifies the interweaving of “sky and soil, flying pollinators with root-bound microbes and fungi”; grasses, which produce small flowers along stalks and “evolved hidden biochemical superpowers”; seagrasses, distantly related to land grasses, which provide habitats for aquatic animal life; roses, whose volatile oils—and alluring fragrance— is a result of “genetic exuberance”; teas, once a mainstay of international trade; and pansies, both field pansies and the hundreds of new varieties bred by horticulturists. Haskell speculates on the future evolution of flowers as they respond to environmental challenges wrought by humans, such as climate change and impoverished soil.

Flowers are “genetically malleable and resilient,” able to change their strategies of reproduction—from showy blooms to attract pollinators to self-fertilization, for example. Besides bringing beauty and joy into the world, flowers, Haskell asserts, can teach humans an important lesson: “Thriving worlds grow from cooperation, mediated by beauty, with some illusion thrown in.” A final chapter suggests playful ways to connect with flowers.

A-MAZE-ING AIRPORT ADVENTURE

Kirkus Reviews

Munro, who knows her way around a maze, here fits a series of them into a simple storyline about a child who's taking a trip to visit Grandmother, accompanied by Mom and Dad. Written in second person addressed to readers, the book starts at Sunny-side Airport, and from there, we move—never in a straight line!—through departures, check-in, security, airport shops and the food court, and terminals into a wonderfully roomy plane interior. At last, it's time to take off: "UP, UP, AND AWAY!" Large, intricate, full-color spreads are rendered in Munro's familiar style, not drawn with super-sharp outlines but nevertheless perfectly clear.

In addition to the winding mazes, each double-page spread includes a challenging list of items to find, including (on each spread) "a copy of this book." Direct instructions ("After Security,

you enter the FOOD COURT and SHOPS. First get a cold drink") guides readers through the mazes; an answer key keeps frustration at bay while providing useful and reassuring flying facts. The people depicted are diverse in terms of skin tone and ability; the protagonist never appears (the artwork is depicted from the youngster's perspective). Whether preparing for a trip or whiling away hours on a flight, readers will find this book absorbing and informative.

IN BRIEF

Justin Gage, *Aquarium Drunkard*: The nom de plume of Angeleno studio veteran Kenny Woods, *Destroyer* is a self-described "tongue-in-cheek, post-pandemic ode to Los Angeles". With a collected and steady prose in the mold of a modern Zevon, the charming pop songwriting eliminates any semblance of novelty from such insular, regional thematics. Topical subject matter aside, the album's deep surveying of the city's sprawling and ever-changing shadows is an elaborate preservation act - hypothetical or otherwise. A record where Brando characters sit comfortably next to Beefheart.

Jo Borrás, *Electrek*:

The worst kind of vehicle emissions aren't the ones that move dirt or haul freight – they're the ones that don't. Every hour, every minute, ever second a combustion engine spends idling at a truck stop or job site is fuel burned, money lost, and air polluted for no productive reason. Vanair's patented solar panel system for semi trucks is ready to help slash idle times.

more...

Into the Gloss, Into the Gloss: The creator of Glossier's perfume line on how he got his start, his personal fragrance preferences, and the inspiration behind Glossier You Doux and Rêve

Into the Gloss, Into the Gloss: Where fashion's favorite pastry chef goes out to blow off steam, and the OG scented lip balm she buys in bulk

Justin Gage, *Aquarium Drunkard*: A sojourn into any old Paris nightclub, circa late seventies. The suave and funk-laced exotica from those speakers just might have sounded like something straight from Yukihiro Takahashi's glossy debut record *Saravah!* While 1978 was the year of the Yellow Magic Orchestra trio's pivotal debut record, it also marked the debut solo offerings of members Ryuichi Sakamoto (Thousand Knives) and Takahashi. A suave affair featuring his YMO bandmates and other Japanese all-stars like guitarist Shigeru Suzuki, Takahashi takes on Italian and French pop, borrows elements from his previous glam/art-rock group Sadistic Mika Band and much more.

Peter Johnson, *Electrek*:

After introducing the first mass-produced EV with a semi-solid-state battery, MG Motor said it will bring the new battery tech to Europe by the end of 2026. In China, the new MG4 with a semi-solid-state battery starts at under \$15,000. Although not that cheap, the new EV is expected to remain affordable in Europe.

Rhian H. Nguyen, *Call Me At The End Of The World*: A collection of short stories and essays exploring the complexities of love, loss, and the human condition. The book is a beautiful blend of fiction and non-fiction, offering a unique perspective on the world we live in.

How I backup

Derek Sivers

Some people have asked, so here is how I do my backups. It takes me about ten seconds per day and five minutes per month to maintain.

It works well for me, but I'm always open to suggestions. Just email me with any ideas or questions.

every-day documents (40 GB)

Files I use and change every day: documents, emails, code, diary, ideas, website, accounts, etc.

I have a desktop and a laptop, so I keep this 40 GB directory cloned with rsync every day or so between them. Whenever I turn on one computer, I sync it from the other.

Daily rsync to an encrypted Linux USB stick attached to the desktop.

Daily rsync to an encrypted MacOS USB stick attached to the laptop.

Daily rsync to an encrypted ZFS SSD inside the desktop.

Daily rsync to OpenBSD remote attached storage at vultr.com as described at my "Tech Independence" page .

I've written shortcuts for these rsync commands so it's really as simple as me typing bkz or bkstick in the terminal as I'm working anyway. I do it a few times a day, especially if I've just made or saved something of value. And always right before I shut down the computer, which I do almost any time I step away from it for more than a few minutes. That's why I say it's like ten seconds a day, just typing that command occasionally.

keepsakes (3 TB)

Rarely-accessed files I want to keep forever: videos and photos of my kid, music and film collection.

Three different external 4TB 2.5" drives, in three different formats: ZFS, OpenBSD, MacOS.

Every month or so, I connect them via USB cable, and rsync everything

PEN PALS

Kirkus Reviews

Having established in the opener that being “Poetry Pals” is far better than being predator and prey, Coelophysis and Frog set off to see the world and learn to write about it. They start by alternating spontaneous rhyming lines, advance to two-word poems that they dub “Blue Poos,” and finish up with “sound poems” created with a chorus of hooting, honking Parasaurolophus. Along the way, a supposedly bad—but really funny—poem (“How does a T-Rex pick his nose? / Arms too short, so he uses his toes!”) leads to a frantic flight from its irate subject, while an Archeopteryx named Hope drops in and out of view to fuel bits of wordplay and a wistful concrete poem from smitten Coelophysis: “I hope / to see / Hope / soon / and / hopefully / Hope / hopes / what I / hope.” Like the poems, the illustrations seem both simple and unpolished at first

and, OK, second glances. But the hand-lettered verses and the googly-eyed dinos, both of which Angleberger places on layered swatches of creased and deckle-edged paper for a 3-D look, carry more than enough vim to leave budding poets roaring to join this brand-new writer’s group in its collective closing “ALL RIGHT!!!! Let’s WRITE!!!!”

Daydreaming the downside, for once

Derek Sivers

A few years ago, I thought it would be fun to get into camping.

I live in New Zealand! How can I not? I daydreamed about it, picturing how much fun it could be. I read a book about it.

I carefully picked out then bought some highly-recommended gear: a tent, two sleeping bags, two air mattresses, and a light backpack.

We used it once. It’s still in my garage.

...

Last year, I thought it would be fun to get a Maschine .

A new way of making music! I daydreamed about it, picturing how much fun it could be. I read about it and watched videos about it.

After a few weeks of this, I felt the time was right. I bought one. I played with it a while for the first day, then got back to my normal life, intending to spend more time with it. But I never did.

Every day I would look at it, thinking I should use it. After half a year, I gave up, and gave it to a friend.

...

Last week, I thought it would be fun to get a new bicycle.

I’ve never tried a carbon frame, modern gearing , or any of the cool new developments in bicycle tech. I live in Oxford, a cycling city ! How can I not?

I’ve been daydreaming about it, picturing how much fun it could be.

Wait!

Hold on. Have I learned nothing?

So I tried picturing the downside, instead.

I pictured myself not using it, like the camping gear, Maschine, and other things I didn’t mention here.

I remembered the pain of guilt, regret, and waste.

The conflicted feelings of wanting this thing, but not quite enough.

And I decided against it.

...

That said, I’m not sure what to conclude.

The only mistake was buying instead of renting?

Give up on trying new things, and just amplify my current focus?

Daydream and learn all about new things, but stop thinking I need to own them? (Awareness is enough for me?)

Or maybe the mistake was giving up? Building new habits takes time and effort. After that initial challenge, my life could be richer by the expanded activities in my repertoire.

Something else?

‘Marshals’ Luke Grimes Thought He Was Done With ‘Yellowstone’ — He Was Wrong

Christina Radish · Collider

“The jeans are a little different. I think I was just skinnier back then. But everything else still fits,” Grimes jokes on a sunny day in New York as we talk about the character that he has become most closely associated with — and one that is clearly very special to him. Wearing a plaid Pendleton and looking as if he could have just stepped off a ranch, even though Season 1 has already wrapped, doesn’t feel especially surprising. After all, he has played Kayce through five seasons of *Yellowstone* and now 13 episodes of *Marshals*, which has since been renewed for Season 2. Landing the role of the former Navy SEAL-turned-rancher marked a turning point in his life and career — one that has made him more recognizable, but also brought a sense of stability in an unpredictable industry.

Travel without a phone

Derek Sivers

The first time, it was an accident.

I’d always wanted to go to Korea. I was so excited. I set out to explore and forgot my phone in the hotel.

I walked around Seoul for twelve hours that day and experienced so many wonderful things. I remember them all vividly now, years later, but I have no photos of it.

It was a relief to not document everything.

I appreciated everything as a one-step process instead of a two-step process. I could just feel amazed, instead of feel amazed and hold up my camera to record it. Besides, how often do I look at those photos later, anyway? I find it more useful to refer to my journal of how I felt, instead of what I saw.

A few times, GPS could have helped, but because I didn’t have it, I had to go ask strangers for directions. Getting lost led me down some great little back roads I never would have found if I was following the map.

So now I intentionally travel without a phone.

I feel free and untethered. A break from connection.

Where you are is partially defined by where you are not. When you’re somewhere, you’re not somewhere else. But when you use your phone, you’re everywhere. You keep in touch with friends. You hear what’s going on at home. You see the screen

exactly as you do anywhere else.

It’s wonderful to be cut off from everywhere else — to be more fully only there.

And it’s so nice to not know the time or where I am. Clocks and maps are useful inventions, but I see a moment better without them.

I appreciate a moment more when I know I’ll never see it again.

I remember that day in Seoul better than I remember most photo-filled travels.

Getting lost led me down some great little back roads I never would have found if I was following the map.

Derek Sivers

Carpenters' tools

Derek Sivers

Two carpenters were fixing some stairs. The older one liked to work. The younger one liked to question.

The older one grabbed a measuring tape from the toolbox and started measuring. The younger one said, "What would be the perfect tool?"

The older one grabbed a saw and started cutting. The younger one said, "It would probably be a thick heavy level with a blade, ruler, chisel and saw, all built-in."

The older one grabbed a chisel and started fixing the edge. The younger one said, "Like a giant Swiss Army knife for professionals, to help us be really productive."

The older one grabbed a sanding block and finished the sanding. The younger one said, "That'd be so efficient, it'd be the only tool I'd ever need."

The job was finished, so the older one put away his tools and closed the toolbox to go. The younger one said, "Unless it would be smarter to just master the chisel, like a sculptor, right?" He kept talking as they left.

...

Some people want one perfect solution that solves every problem. They need everything to fit — consistent and congruent. The rest of us use whatever tool helps us do what we need to do. When someone refuses to use a tool because it's not perfect, they're probably not actually doing the work.

The younger one said, "That'd be so efficient, it'd be the only tool I'd ever need."

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